



Standard Operating Procedure: Blood collection and Phlebotomy Guidelines

Effective Date: April 10, 2026

Review Date: March 17, 2027

Scope: Clinical Operations & Administrative Staff

Purpose and Scope

To ensure diagnostic integrity and staff safety during blood collection. This procedure provides the framework for compliance with OSHA's mandate to eliminate occupational exposure to bloodborne pathogens and ISO's standards for reducing pre-analytical errors.

Safety and Regulatory Compliance

OSHA Compliance (29 CFR 1910.1030)

Universal/Standard Precautions: Treat all human blood and Body Fluids (OPIM) as if known to be infectious for HIV, HBV, and HCV.

Engineering Controls: Use only safety-engineered sharps (e.g., self-sheathing needles or needleless systems). Sharps containers must be puncture-resistant, labeled/color-coded, and leak-proof on the sides and bottom.

Work Practice Controls:

- **Prohibited Actions:** No recapping, bending, or breaking of needles. No eating, drinking, or applying cosmetics in collection areas.
- **Hand Hygiene:** Mandatory washing immediately after glove removal or any contact with blood.
- **Exposure Protocol:** In the event of a needlestick, immediately wash the site with soap and water and follow the facility's Exposure Control Plan (ECP) for medical evaluation and post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP).



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ISO Quality Standards (ISO 15189:2022)

- **Pre-analytical Integrity:** Standardizing patient preparation, "Order of Draw," and tube inversions to ensure sample stability.
- **Traceability:** Every sample must be unequivocally linked to a specific patient and a specific collector via unique identifiers (e.g., Barcode/LIS).
- **Competence:** Only personnel who have undergone documented training and annual competency assessments are authorized to perform venipuncture.
- **Sample Acceptance/Rejection:** Criteria must be established for rejecting samples (e.g., hemolysis, incorrect volume, or mislabeling) to protect the validity of clinical results.

Pre-Collection Preparation

Materials & Equipment

- **PPE:** Gloves (non-latex), lab coats, and face shields (if splashing is anticipated).
- **Collection Tools:** Safety needles, Vacutainer® holders, and expiration-validated tubes.
- **Antiseptics:** 70% Isopropyl alcohol or Chlorhexidine.
- **Environment:** Non-porous, easily disinfectable work surfaces.

Patient Identification (ISO 7.2.2)

- **Dual Identifiers:** Confirm name and DOB.
- **Assessment:** Check for fasting status or specific medication timing required for the test.
- **Consent:** Obtain and document verbal or written consent as per local policy.



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Blood Collection Procedure

- ✓ **Hand Hygiene & Site Preparation:**
 - Sanitize hands and don gloves (change gloves between every patient).
 - Apply tourniquet (max 60 seconds).
- ✓ **Aseptic Technique:** Clean site in a concentric circle; air dry to prevent hemolysis (ISO requirement).
- ✓ **Needle Insertion & Tube Handling**
 - **Angle:** Insert at a 15°–30° angle with the bevel up.
 - **Safety:** Once flow starts, release the tourniquet.
 - **Order of Draw:** Follow CLSI/ISO standard to prevent additive cross-contamination.

Blood Culture -> Citrate -> Serum -> Heparin -> EDTA -> Oxalate/Fluoride
 - **Mixing:** Gently invert tubes (5–10 times). Never shake.
- ✓ **Post-Collection & Waste Management**
 - **Needle Disposal (OSHA Mandate)**
 - **Immediate Activation:** Engage the safety mechanism immediately upon withdrawal.
 - **Point-of-Use Disposal:** Drop the assembly directly into the sharps container. Do not carry unsheathed needles across the room.



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✓ **Documentation & Transport**

- Label tubes at the bedside. Labels must include: Patient ID, Date/Time of collection, and Collector ID.
- Place samples in a biohazard bag with the requisition in the side pocket (to prevent contamination of the paperwork).
- Ensure transport temperature meets ISO requirements for the specific test (e.g., chilled for Ammonia or Lactic Acid).

✓ **Decontamination**

Clean all reusable equipment and surfaces with a 1:10 bleach solution or EPA-approved disinfectant after each patient

Prepared by:

Rheinalei Aubrey Co, RMT, DTA, MLS (ASCP) cm
Clinical Operations Lead

Approved by:

Cj Johnson

CEO/Founder



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